
MEETING MINUTES

October 21, 2024

Regular Meeting: 5:15-6:30 PM

- I. Roll Call for Attendance of Members and Student Representatives - 6/1
- II. Salute the Flag
- III. Consent Agenda
 - Approval of Bills and Payrolls
 - Approval of Capital Purchases
 - Approval of Grants
 - Approval of Field Trips
 - Approval of Meeting Minutes
 - Regular Meeting, October 7, 2024
 - Strategic and Capital Planning, October 15, 2024

Motion to approve consent agenda with Strategic and Capital Planning minutes severed by Member Branley, second by Member Olapade - 6/1

Motion to table Strategic and Capital Planning minutes from October 15, 2024 by Member Ruseau, second by Member Graham - 6/1

- IV. Report of Subcommittees
 - A. **Strategic and Capital Planning Update** - Member Graham, Chair

5:21 p.m. All School Committee Members Present - 7/0

- V. Report of the Superintendent
 - 1. **Superintendent's Updates and Comments** - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Superintendent
 - 2. **Report on Water Testing** - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Superintendent and Dr. Peter J. Cushing, Assistant Superintendent of Enrichment, Innovation and Operations and Department of Environmental Protection (DEP) Representatives: Alex Smith-Lin, Project Manager (UMASS Amherst); Hannah Parzen, Project Manager (UMASS Amherst); Yvette Depeiza, Program Director, and Jessica Sibirski, Environmental Analyst, Marian Berkowitz Technical Assistance Provider (UMASS Amherst), and Kate Gallagher, Technical Assistance Provider (UMASS Amherst)
 - Department of Environmental Protection - it is very common for lead to be found in this type of testing in schools.
 - Flushing programs are regularly suggested in the interim of the stations being installed.

- City is researching different ways lead could be coming in.
 - Any place where there is concern has a sign that states “Hand Washing Only”.
 - Medford High is not the facility that tested the highest overall so the age of the building was not a factor.
 - Save fixtures that are removed so we can test them.
 - What is the flushing protocol?
 - Recommended to run the water for 30 seconds minimum at the start of the day before using it in reliable settings such as nurse’s office, kitchen, after holiday breaks and periods of times where there has been no use for an extended period of time.
 - Use patterns are very important for testing results. Higher levels in less frequently used fixtures and piping.
3. **Report on District Wide Busing** - Dr. Peter J. Cushing, Assistant Superintendent of Enrichment, Innovation and Operations, Ms. Megan Fidler Carey, Director of Family and Community Engagement and Mr. Chuck Winitzer, Owner of Eastern Bus Company, and Ms. Jessica Guadalupe, Eastern Bus Medford Manager
- Chuck Winitzer spoke on the huge shortage of drivers, not just for Medford. As a company we train in accordance with the state to support all the communities we serve.
 - Medford and Malden do not have the most drivers applying.
 - Consistently we lose drivers right before the start of the school year.
 - We will add buses as soon as we are able to get drivers.
 - We have been diligent in our efforts to recruit drivers.
 - Fluid situation, hoping to add drivers in the next few weeks.
 - How can the Committee help with the bus shortage and support you?
 - Unfortunately, there is not anything at this time.
 - Parents are paying for services that kids are not getting to on time.
 - Traffic is an issue and we can not control what happens on the highway which then leads to a backup in Medford because of where it is located.
 - Is there anything we can do to ensure kids are safer and not get out at the wrong place?
 - Cambridge hires monitors for every bus
 - Staff members need to ensure that students get to the right bus.
 - Tags for all students labeling stops
 - New student labeling for drivers
 - We are optimistic that by spring we will be in better shape.

Presentations of the Public (not to begin before 7:00 pm)

VI. Continued Business

2024-34 Offered by Member Ruseau

Second reading of Policy ADC - Tobacco Products on School Premises Prohibited

Tobacco Use on School Property by Staff Members Prohibited

Use of any tobacco products, including, but not limited to: cigarettes, cigars, little cigars, chewing tobacco, pipe tobacco and snuff and electronic cigarettes, electronic cigars, electronic pipes or other similar products that rely on vaporization or aerosolization, within the school buildings, school facilities, on school grounds or school buses, or at school-sponsored events by any individual, including school personnel, is prohibited at all times.

Staff members who violate this policy will be referred to their immediate supervisor.

Policy Information

First Adopted: Unknown

Last Amended: TBD

Last Reviewed: TBD

Review Frequency: five (5) years

Next Review: TBD

Version: 2

Policy ID: GBED

Original Source: MASC - 2022

Legal References:

M.G.L. [71:37H](#)

Cross References:

[ADC](#), Tobacco Products on School Premises Prohibited

[JICH](#), Alcohol, Tobacco and Drug Use by Students Prohibited

Date Submitted: September 18, 2023 / First Reading Approved, September 23, 2024

Date Requested to be on the Agenda: October 21, 2024

Motion to waive reading by Member Ruseau, second by Member Graham - 7/0

Motion to approve by Member Graham, second by Member Olapade - 7/0

2024-36 Offered by Member Ruseau

Second reading of Policy GBED - Tobacco Use on School Property by Staff Members Prohibited

Use of any tobacco products, including, but not limited to, cigarettes, cigars, little cigars, chewing tobacco, pipe tobacco, snuff, electronic cigarettes, electronic cigars, electronic pipes, nicotine pouches or other similar products that rely on vaporization or aerosolization within the school buildings, school facilities, on school grounds or school buses, or at school-sponsored events by any individual, including school personnel and students, is prohibited at all times.

The use of prescription nicotine cessation products are excluded from this policy.

A staff member determined to be in violation of this policy shall be subject to disciplinary action.

A student determined to be in violation of this policy shall be subject to disciplinary action pursuant to the student discipline code.

This policy shall be promulgated to all staff and students in the appropriate handbook(s) and publications.

Signs shall be posted in all school buildings informing the general public of the District policy and requirements of state law.

Policy Information

First Adopted: Unknown

Last Amended: None

Last Reviewed: None

Review Frequency: five (5) years

Next Review: TBD

Version: 2

Policy ID: ADC

Original Source: MASC - 2022

Legal References:

M.G.L. [71:37H](#)

M.G.L. [270:6](#)

Cross References:

[GBED](#), Tobacco Products on School Premises Prohibited

[JICH](#), Alcohol, Tobacco and Drug Use by Students Prohibited

Date Submitted: September 18, 2024/ First Reading Approved, October 7, 2024

Date Requested to be on the Agenda: October 21, 2024

Motion to waive second reading by Member Ruseau, second by Member Olapade - 7/0

Motion to approve by Member Reinfeld, second by Member Intoppa - 7/0

VII. New Business

VIII. Reports Requested

IX. Condolences

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **Edward C. Ogonosky**, father of Missituk educator Stephanie Ogonosky and retired Medford firefighter.

X. Next Regular Meeting

November 4, 2024 to be held by remote participation only to accommodate the election process.

XI. Adjournment

Motion to adjourn by Member Branley, second by Member Graham - 7/0

Meeting adjourned at 6:46 pm